WESTBROOK CURRENTS
Local events. Community connections.

Westbrook Help Guide

Help with heat, electricity and food for people who live in Westbrook, Maine.

Need help right now?
Life-threatening emergency: call **911**.
Help finding food, fuel or other help any time: dial **211**, or text your ZIP code to **898-211**.

How to use this guide

Each section has the same parts: urgent numbers first, then who may qualify, then what to get ready, then the steps in order. Start with Step 1 and keep going only if you need more help.

Call first. Most offices want you to phone before you visit, and many do not take walk-ins.

Inside this guide

Heating and Fuel	Help paying for heating oil, propane and other heat.
Electricity	Help with your electric bill, payment plans and winter shutoff rules.
Food	Pantries, SNAP, WIC, Meals on Wheels and more.

The newest version is always on the website.

Scan the code, or visit westbrookcurrents.com/help. Phone numbers, rules and dates can change, so check the website before you go.

This guide was made on Oct 16, 2026. Each program shows the date we last checked it.

Help Paying for Heat

Programs that may help Westbrook residents pay for heat.

Heating costs a lot in Maine winters. Help comes from a few places. Check your income, then follow the steps in order.

Almost out of fuel?

Call the local agency now to book an appointment:

(207) 553-5800

Life-threatening emergency?

Call 911. For help finding fuel funds any time, dial 211.

Check your income first

Heating, repair and sealing programs use the same limit. Add up everyone's income before taxes.

People in home	Per month	Per year
1	$3,173	$38,070
2	$4,149	$49,784
3	$5,125	$61,498
4	$6,101	$73,213
5	$7,077	$84,927
6	$8,053	$96,641

Season 2026-2027. Over the limit? You may be able to subtract some medical costs. More than 6 people? See the official chart.

Source: mainehousing.org: HEAP income chart. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Get these ready

- [ ] Photo ID
- [ ] Proof of income for everyone in your home, and your other money records
- [ ] Recent heating and electric bills
- [ ] Your fuel type and your fuel dealer's name
- [ ] Names and birth dates for everyone in your home

Bring all of your financial records to your appointment. Each program may ask for more, so check its official page.

YOUR LOCAL AGENCY

The Opportunity Alliance

Takes heating applications for Cumberland County, which includes Westbrook. Call first to make an appointment. Please do not walk in.

Call: (207) 553-5800

Official page: opportunityalliance.org/heap

Source: opportunityalliance.org/heap. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Follow these steps

STEP 1

Apply for HEAP

The main heating program | 1 program

FOR ALL RESIDENTS

Home Energy Assistance Program (HEAP)

[Income limit applies]

Help paying part of your heating bill. The money goes to your fuel dealer. It does not cover the whole winter.

Homeowners and renters under the income limit. Apply from August through May.

Call: (207) 553-5800

Official page: mainehousing.org/heap

Source: mainehousing.org/heap. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 2

Running low on fuel?

Emergency help after you apply | 1 program

EMERGENCY FUEL

Energy Crisis Intervention Program (ECIP)

[Waiting on funding, expected in November]

Emergency fuel when you are almost out. You need an approved HEAP application first. It usually opens November 1.

This year the agency is waiting to hear about funding, which it expects sometime in November 2026. The start date and amount will be shared when they are announced. Until then, call to ask.

Call: (207) 553-5800

Official page: opportunityalliance.org/ecip

Source: opportunityalliance.org/ecip. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 3

Heater broken or drafty?

Repairs and sealing | 3 programs

HEATER REPAIR

Central Heating Improvement Program (CHIP)

[Income limit applies]

Money to repair or replace a heating system. Homes with no heat come first.

Some households pay part of the cost.

Call: (207) 553-5800

Official page: mainehousing.org/programs-services/energy/energydetails/CHIP

Source: mainehousing.org: CHIP. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

SEAL UP YOUR HOME

Weatherization Assistance

[Income limit applies]

A free home energy check, then work like sealing air leaks and adding insulation.

Renters need the landlord to agree to the work.

Call: (207) 553-5800

Official page: mainehousing.org/programs-services/HomeImprovement/homeimprovementdetail/weatherization

Source: mainehousing.org: Weatherization. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

ANY INCOME

Efficiency Maine insulation rebates

[No income limit for basic rebates]

Rebates for insulation and air sealing. Lower income households get bigger rebates.

A registered Efficiency Maine vendor must do the work.

Official page: efficiencymaine.com/at-home/insulation-rebates-up-to-8600

Source: efficiencymaine.com: Insulation rebates. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 4

Other help

For veterans, and for everyone | 2 programs

VETERANS

Veterans' Emergency Financial Assistance

[Based on need, not a set income limit]

One-time emergency money for Maine veterans with no savings or other help.

Ask if heating costs count. Contact Easterseals Maine.

Call: (207) 828-0754 ext. 1004

Official page: maine.gov/veterans/benefits/tax-finance-benefits/vefa.html

Source: maine.gov/veterans: VEFA. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

ANYONE

211 Maine

[Open to anyone]

A free help line that can point you to local fuel funds and help set up a fuel delivery.

You can also text your ZIP code to 898-211.

Call: 211

Official page: 211maine.org/?p=1431

Source: 211maine.org. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 5

Last stop

Only when other programs are not enough | 1 program

LAST RESORT

Westbrook General Assistance

[Based on your 30-day budget]

City help for basic needs like heat when other programs are not enough. Appointment only, no walk-ins.

Based on income for 30 days at a time. You must apply to other programs first.

Call: 207-591-7015

What to expect at General Assistance: westbrookcurrents.com/help/general-assistance

Official page: westbrookmaine.gov/194/General-Assistance

Source: westbrookmaine.gov: General Assistance. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Help Paying for Electricity

Programs that may help Westbrook residents pay the electric bill.

Maine has new help for electric bills starting in the fall of 2026. Most Westbrook homes get power from Central Maine Power (CMP). Check your bill to be sure. Then follow the steps below.

Worried about a shutoff?

Call your electric company first. For CMP:

800-686-4044

Still stuck? Call the state's Consumer Assistance office:

800-452-4699 (Monday to Friday, 9 a.m. to 4 p.m.)

Life-threatening emergency?

Call 911. For help finding other aid any time, dial 211.

Who may qualify

Most electric help is for households with lower incomes. You may qualify if you are approved for heating help (HEAP), or you get SNAP, TANF or MaineCare, or your income is at or below 150% of the federal poverty level.

Heating help and electric help use many of the same papers. If you apply for one, ask about the other. See the heating income limits.

Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Get these ready

- [ ] Your latest electric bill, with your account number
- [ ] Photo ID
- [ ] Proof of income, or letters about SNAP, TANF or MaineCare
- [ ] Names and birth dates for everyone in your home

The electric bill must be in the name of someone in your home. Each program may ask for more, so check its official page.

YOUR LOCAL AGENCY

The Opportunity Alliance

The local Community Action Agency for Cumberland County, which includes Westbrook. It helps with electric programs, and with heating help. Call first to make an appointment. Please do not walk in.

Call: (207) 553-5800

Official page: maine.gov/mpuc/consumer-assistance/programs

Source: maine.gov/mpuc: assistance programs. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Follow these steps

STEP 1

Check your latest CMP bill

A new monthly discount | 1 program

FOR LOWER-INCOME HOUSEHOLDS

Low Income Assistance Program (LIAP)

[Income limit applies]

A monthly discount on your electric bill. Starting in the fall of 2026, many CMP customers who qualify are signed up without having to apply.

The state says CMP discounts run from 25% to 81% of the bill, based on income. Look for a discount on your latest bill. The state says it should show on the November bill or later. No discount and you think you qualify? Call CMP, or ask the local agency. You can choose to opt out.

Call: (877) 544-3271

Official page: maine.gov/governor/mills/index.php/news/governor-mills-announces-automatic-electric-bill-discounts-thousands-maine-families-2026-10-01

Source: maine.gov: Governor's announcement. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 2

Behind on your bill?

Payment plans and old bills | 2 programs

FROM YOUR ELECTRIC COMPANY

CMP payment help

[Open to CMP customers]

CMP can set up a payment plan if you are behind. It also has programs for people with medical needs.

Ask about payment plans, SimplePay and medical emergency protection. You can call, or sign in to My Account online.

Call: 800-686-4044

Official page: cmpco.com/account/waystopay/help-with-bill

Source: cmpco.com: ways to get help. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

IF YOU OWE MONEY

Arrearage Management Program (AMP)

[Rules apply]

Helps erase an old electric bill. Over 12 months, part of what you owe is wiped out each month you pay on time. CMP says up to $500 a month.

This is for people behind on their bill who are in the LIAP or HEAP programs. Ask the local agency if you qualify.

Call: (207) 553-5800

Official page: maine.gov/mpuc/consumer-assistance/programs

Source: maine.gov/mpuc: assistance programs. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 3

Afraid of a shutoff?

Winter protection | 1 program

NOV 15 TO APR 15

Winter shutoff protection

[Open to all residents]

From Nov 15 to Apr 15, an electric company must get the state's permission before it can shut off a home's power.

Call your electric company first and ask for a payment plan. Still worried? Call the state at 800-452-4699, Monday to Friday, 9 to 4. They do not take walk-ins.

Call: 800-452-4699

Official page: maine.gov/mpuc/consumer-assistance

Source: maine.gov/mpuc: Consumer Assistance. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 4

Lower your bill

Rebates and a help line | 2 programs

LOWER YOUR BILL

Efficiency Maine rebates

[Income tiers apply]

Rebates on heat pumps, insulation and other upgrades can lower your energy use. Lower-income households get the biggest rebates.

Rebate amounts can change, so check the official page or call before you buy.

Call: 866-376-2463

Official page: efficiencymaine.com/at-home

Source: efficiencymaine.com: at home. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

ANYONE

211 Maine

[Open to anyone]

A free help line that can point you to utility help near you.

You can also text your ZIP code to 898-211.

Call: 211

Official page: 211maine.org/?p=1431

Source: 211maine.org. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 5

Are you a veteran?

Extra help for veterans | 1 program

FOR VETERANS

Veterans' emergency help

[Based on need]

Maine has an emergency money program for veterans. The state says it can help with rent, utilities and other urgent costs.

Ask if your electric bill counts, then apply with the form on the official page. The state's Public Advocate also lists Veterans Forward (347-443-0005) and USA Cares (1-800-773-0387) for veterans who are behind on bills.

Official page: maine.gov/veterans/maine-veterans-assistance

Source: maine.gov/veterans: assistance for veterans. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 6

Last stop

Only when other programs are not enough | 1 program

LAST RESORT

Westbrook General Assistance

[Based on your 30-day budget]

City help for basic needs like heat and electricity when other programs are not enough. Appointment only, no walk-ins.

Based on income for 30 days at a time. You must apply to other programs first.

Call: 207-591-7015

What to expect at General Assistance: westbrookcurrents.com/help/general-assistance

Official page: westbrookmaine.gov/194/General-Assistance

Source: westbrookmaine.gov: General Assistance. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Help Getting Food

Programs that may help Westbrook residents get food.

If money is tight, you do not have to go hungry. Some help is free for anyone. Some depends on your income. Start with the step that fits you.

Need food today?

Dial 211 any time to find food near you, or text your ZIP code to 898-211.

Life-threatening emergency?

Call 911.

Who may qualify

Pantries and food maps are open to anyone. SNAP and WIC have income limits. Meals on Wheels is for older adults who need help getting meals.

Not sure if you qualify? Apply anyway. The program will tell you.
Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Follow these steps

STEP 1

Need food now?

Free food, no income check | 5 programs

FREE FOOD IN WESTBROOK

Westbrook Community Food & Resource Center

[Tuesdays, 11 a.m. to 1 p.m.]

The city’s volunteer food pantry at the Westbrook Community Center. Open every Tuesday from 11 a.m. to 1 p.m.

First time? Bring proof you live in Westbrook, like a utility bill or rent bill. Hours can change, so call if you are not sure.

Call: 207-591-8147

Official page: westbrookmaine.gov/292/Westbrook-Community-Food-Resource-Center

Source: westbrookmaine.gov: Community Food & Resource Center. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

FREE FOOD IN WESTBROOK

Vineyard Church Food Pantry

[Fridays, 5:45 p.m.]

A church pantry at 715 Bridgton Road. Food is handed out on Fridays starting at 5:45 p.m. It serves Westbrook and Portland residents who live west of Riverside.

Arrive by 5 p.m. and line up in your car. Hours can change, so call the church office if you are not sure.

Call: (207) 854-8339

Official page: waysidemaine.org/surroundingtownswestbrook

Source: Wayside Food Programs; times confirmed by a pantry coordinator, Oct 16, 2026. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

FREE FOOD IN WESTBROOK

The Locker Project at Walker Memorial Library

[First Thursday, 11 a.m. to noon]

Free fresh food for anyone to take home, on the first Thursday of each month in the library's Youth Program Room. Next visits: Nov. 5 and Dec. 3.

Bring a bag or box if you can. Dates can change, so check the City calendar or call the Locker Project.

Call: (207) 899-9540

Official page: westbrookmaine.gov/Calendar.aspx?EID=3650

Source: westbrookmaine.gov: Locker Project event. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

FIND FOOD NEAR YOU

Good Shepherd Food Bank: Food Map

[Open to anyone]

A map of pantries, meal sites and other food help across Maine. It includes a mobile pantry called the Food Mobile.

Open the official page and choose the Food Map. Check hours with each place before you go.

Official page: gsfb.org/get-help

Source: gsfb.org: get help. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

ANYONE

211 Maine

[Open to anyone]

A free help line that can point you to food and other help near you.

You can also text your ZIP code to 898-211.

Call: 211

Official page: 211maine.org/?p=1431

Source: 211maine.org. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 2 Want help every month?

Money for groceries | 1 program

FOR ALL RESIDENTS

SNAP (Food Supplement)

[Income limit applies]

Money on a card (EBT) each month to buy groceries. The limit depends on how many people are in your home.

Apply online, by phone or at a state office. The state has 30 days to decide, and you will have an interview. Over the limit? Some households still qualify, so you can apply anyway. Phone lines are open Monday to Friday, 7 to 4.

Call: 1-855-797-4357

Official page: maine.gov/dhhs/ofi/programs-services/food-supplement

Source: maine.gov: SNAP (Food Supplement). Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 3 Expecting, or have a child under 5?

Food and nutrition help | 1 program

FAMILIES WITH YOUNG CHILDREN

WIC

[Income limit applies]

Food, nutrition help and breastfeeding support for people who are pregnant or breastfeeding, and for children up to age 5.

If you get MaineCare, SNAP or TANF, you already meet the income rule. Use the form on the official page, and WIC staff will call you to set up a visit.

Call: 1-800-437-9300

Official page: maine.gov/dhhs/wic

Source: maine.gov: WIC. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 4

Age 60 or older?

Meals and food for older adults | 3 programs

FOR SENIORS

Meals on Wheels

[No income limit]

Meals brought to your home by the Southern Maine Agency on Aging. It is for people age 60 and older who are mostly homebound and cannot easily make meals.

A $3.50 gift per meal is suggested. No one is turned away if they cannot pay. Fill out the online form or call. The page says it serves York and Cumberland counties.

Call: 1-800-427-7411

Official page: smaaa.org/services-for-older-adults/nutrition/meals-on-wheels

Source: smaaa.org: Meals on Wheels. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

FOR SENIORS

Commodity Supplemental Food Program (CSFP)

[Age 60+, income limit applies]

Free USDA foods each month to add to a senior's groceries.

Wayside Food Programs handles sign-ups for Cumberland County, including Westbrook. Call or use the form on their site. Income limits change each year, so ask when you call.

Call: (207) 775-4939

Official page: maine.gov/dacf/ard/food-assistance/supplemental-food.shtml

Source: maine.gov: supplemental food programs. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

FOR SENIORS

Community Cafes

[Call to ask who can come]

Lunches with other people, run by the Southern Maine Agency on Aging in York and Cumberland counties.

Ask which cafes are close to Westbrook, and what days they meet.

Call: 1-800-427-7411

Official page: smaaa.org/services-for-older-adults/nutrition

Source: smaaa.org: nutrition. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

STEP 5

Last stop

Only when other programs are not enough | 1 program

LAST RESORT

Westbrook General Assistance

[Based on your 30-day budget]

City help for basic needs when other programs are not enough. Appointment only, no walk-ins.

Based on income for 30 days at a time. You must apply to other programs first.

Call: 207-591-7015

What to expect at General Assistance: westbrookcurrents.com/help/general-assistance

Official page: westbrookmaine.gov/194/General-Assistance

Source: westbrookmaine.gov: General Assistance. Last checked Oct 14, 2026.

Please check before you apply.

We worked hard to get this right, but programs, phone numbers and dates change. Check each program or its official page first. Westbrook Currents is independent. It is not run by the City of Westbrook or any agency listed here.

See something wrong? Tell us at westbrookcurrents.com/feedback and we will check it.